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Reference Docket No. 17-04 Regulatory Reform Initiative

Under the present regulations, we as NVOCC/OTI throughout the world have to file rates prior to accepting any business from our accounts. This has been going on since The Shipping Act of 1984. The rules have been changed from time to time, as at one time we could only file rates in a tariff, now we have another option - the Negotiated Rate Agreement. We, Aries Global Logistics, Inc. use the NRA option.

In order to comply with the regulations, we estimate each NRA we process takes a minimum of 10 minutes to prepare, email and ensure that the signed NRA comes back prior to shipment. Based on the quantity of shipments we process as an NVOCC/OTI, that would equate to roughly 46,000 minutes, or 766 hours of processing NRA's. The estimate of the cost to Aries Global would be the equivalent of 19 weeks of salary and benefits or roughly \$40,000 to \$45,000 to process same. This also excludes our client's time of receiving, reviewing, signing, scanning and return of the same, probably costing them an equivalent sum of money.

It is needless for me to say to you that this is expensive and redundant, as we agree to the cost via email prior to generating the NRA, and serves no practical purpose for us or our clients. Simply put, if our rates do not meet the customer's requirements, they will not book the shipment with us.

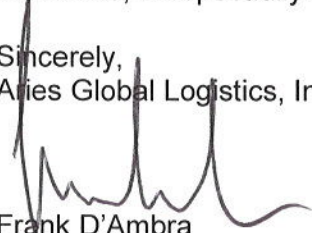
It has always been of interest to our industry that there is no rate filing requirement for air freight, there is no rate requirement for trucking and the same for rail. Therefore, I do not understand why there is a need to file rates for ocean freight. As illustrated in the other modes of transportation, the relationship between the parties works fine without a tariff rate filing requirement. So the question is why is it required for ocean freight as NVOCC/OTI? Why do we have to be burdened in filing rates that actually serve no benefit to the shipping public?

Aries Global Logistics, Inc. is only one of thousands of NVOCC/OTI. If you were to consider the cost across the industry for this regulation to be compiled within its totality, it has to be enormous.

It is my understanding that the purpose of regulations made by a government agency is to protect the public. As stated, this regulation does not serve any party to the transaction and does not meet this criteria and is therefore wasteful.

Therefore, I respectfully request that you eliminate this burdensome, costly regulation.

Sincerely,
Aries Global Logistics, Inc.


Frank D'Ambra
President